



SMART WANDERERS

Road to market intermediate report

Entrepreneurship



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UNDERSTANDING OUR COMMUNITY



The community

Budget-conscious leisure travelers

- Students & young professionals
- Digital natives planning everything online
- Travel 1–3 times per year
- Seek maximum experiences within a fixed budget



Their needs

- Turn a fixed budget into realistic trip options
- Compare destinations based on total trip cost (not just flights)
- Avoid hidden costs and visa/entry surprises
- Save time and reduce planning stress
- Feel confident their trip is affordable and feasible



Existing solution

Trip planning is fragmented

- Travelers rely on separate tools:
- Skyscanner / Google Flights → flights only
- Booking / Airbnb → accommodation
- only Blogs / Reddit → activities & tips
- Embassy websites → visa information

Travelers know how much money they have. They just don't know where that money can realistically take them.

Planning is fragmented, stressful, and full of uncertainty, making travel harder than it should be.

VALIDATING THE NEED

Total Interviews Conducted : 20



What's your current professional status?



Would you be interested in getting professional help with planning your itinerary in exchange for a small fee?



Depending on the trip, domestic or international, how much do you set aside as the spendable amount for the trip?



What would be your expectations from such an arrangement ?

Are most of your trips domestic or international ?



Do you face any issues when you're planning your trips ?



How often do you travel during the year?



PROTOTYPE, MVP & PRELIMINARY VALUE PROPOSITION



Prototype (Lovable Mock-up)

Our initial prototype demonstrated a groundbreaking approach to travel planning, focusing on budget-first search. Users simply input their budget, departure city, and desired dates.

The platform then intelligently suggests flights, hotels, estimated activity costs, and even food and transport estimations, all within their specified budget. The key innovation is shifting from "Where do you want to go?" to "How much do you want to spend?"



MVP

To validate our concept, we developed an MVP focused on core functionality and key assumptions. This allowed us to quickly gather user feedback and iterate.

Preliminary Value Proposition

We identified a significant gap in the market: travel planning is often fragmented and fraught with hidden costs, leading to stress and budget overruns for travellers.

Our value proposition offers full cost visibility, reduced decision fatigue, significant time savings, and complete budget control. Ultimately, we enable travellers to experience the joy of exploration without financial surprises.

What We Built

A static prototype with 5-10 curated destinations, pre-calculated cost breakdowns, and affiliate redirection to booking platforms.

Problem

Fragmented planning, hidden costs, and budget uncertainty.

What We Are Testing

User preference for budget-first search, the impact of full cost transparency on planning stress, and user willingness to book through our platform.

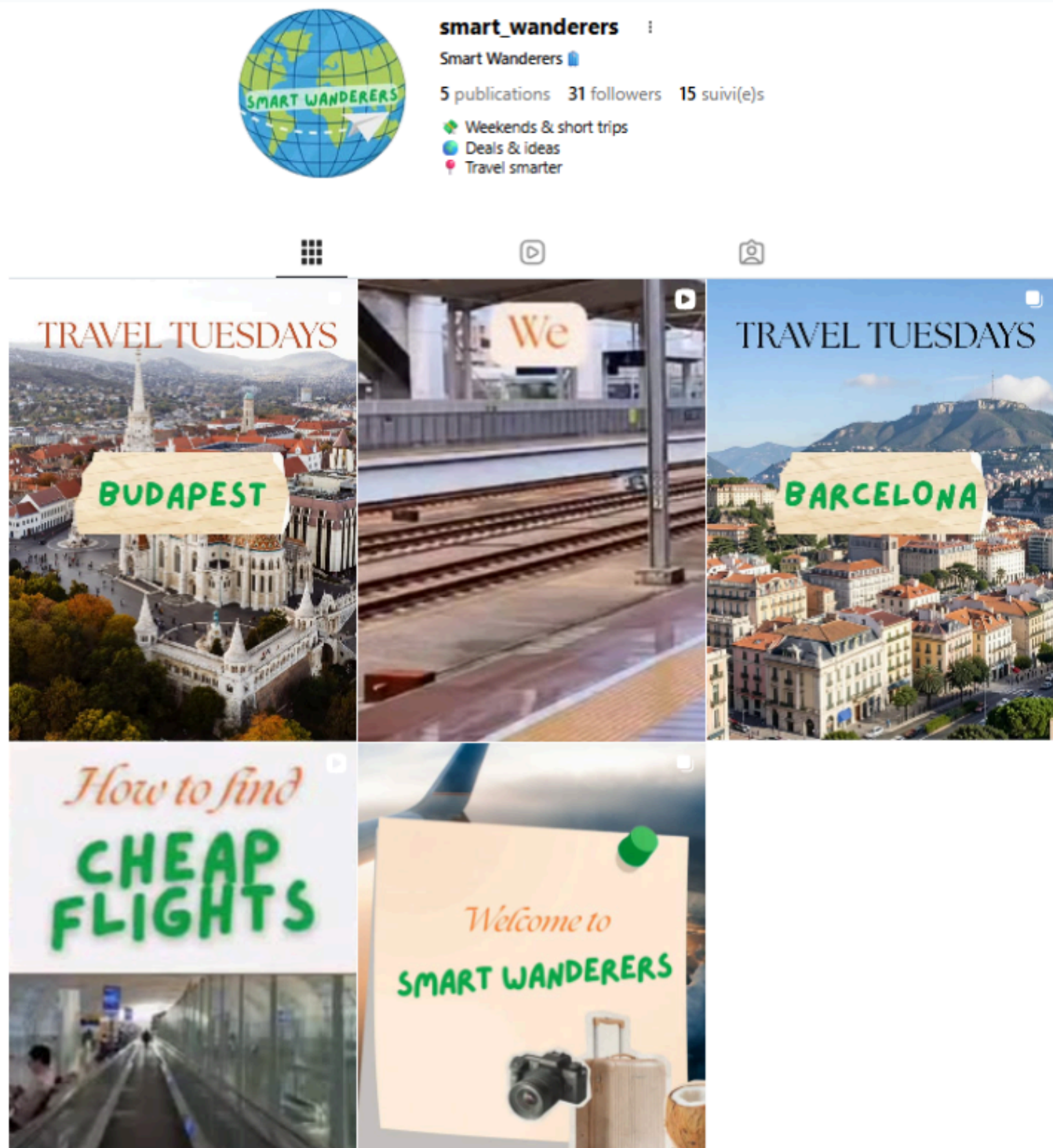
Solution

An integrated platform that optimises complete trips (flights, hotels, activities) around a fixed budget.

The screenshot shows a web interface with a blue header and a white form area. The title "Where will your budget take you?" is in white text on the blue background. Below the title, a subtitle reads: "Enter your budget and travel dates, and we'll find the perfect destinations with estimated prices for flights and hotels." The form contains three sections: "Where are you flying from?" with a text input field and a location icon; "When do you want to travel?" with a date range selector; and "Total Budget" with a slider ranging from \$100 to \$5000+, with a "Comfortable" label and a "\$ 1000" marker. A "Show my trip options" button is at the bottom.

The screenshot shows a web interface with a white background. It has three input fields: "Where are you flying from?" with a location icon, "When do you want to travel?" with a date range selector, and "Total Budget" with a slider ranging from \$100 to \$5000+, with a "Comfortable" label and a "\$ 1000" marker. Below the budget slider, there is a "Trip Style (optional)" section with six buttons: "Relaxing", "Culture", "Food", "Nature", "Nightlife", and "Adventure". A "Show my trip options" button is at the bottom. A footer note says: "Please select your departure airport and travel dates".

BUILDING AN ONLINE PRESENCE



- 31 followers but more than **10x accounts reached** (368) , 1267 views, 119 interactions
- Almost **50% of our views by non followers** (49,9%) – account discovery is in progress
Reels improve discovery beyond followers
- Best performing : Cheap flight advice reel : 265 views, 6 comments.
- “Travel tuesday” post every week (259 and 136 views)
- Average engagement rate : **15,81%** (above average)
- Average likes : **16,2** // Average comments : **4,8**

<https://smartwandererspro.wixsite.com/smart-wanderers>

NEXT STEPS



1.

- Further validate and prioritise core needs
- Strengthen evidence vs existing solutions

2.

- Run additional interviews (problem-solution fit, adoption intent)
- Optimise landing/content pages

3.

- Run further acquisition tests
- Consolidate funnel metrics

4.

- Iterate MVP based on feedback
- Clarify core benefit and differentiation

5.

- Formalise pivots and trade-offs
- Link decisions to data

6.

- Evaluate traction and readiness
- Define post-course next steps



THANK YOU